

ReturnGuard

PPT Pitch Script (3-4 Minutes)

Style: Conversational, explaining key points - NOT reading slides. | Total Time: ~3.5 min

Slide 1 - Title (~15 sec)

So, what we've built is called ReturnGuard. In simple terms - it's a smart system that helps small and mid-size Indian D2C brands stop losing money to return fraud. India's e-commerce has a massive return problem, especially with COD orders, and most small merchants don't have the tools to deal with it. That's the gap ReturnGuard fills.

Slide 2 - Project Overview (~25 sec)

At its core, ReturnGuard is a real-time fraud detection engine. Every time a customer places an order or files a return, the system runs a 0-to-100 risk score against it - instantly.

There are two sides to it - a Shopper Portal where customers manage their orders and returns normally, and a Merchant Portal where the store owner can see exactly what's happening - which returns are risky, which customers are repeat offenders, and what action to take.

The whole point is: catch the bad actors without punishing good customers. 85% of genuine returns get approved instantly with zero friction.

Slide 3 - Challenges & Solutions (~35 sec)

Let me explain the real-world fraud patterns we're solving - because these aren't theoretical, they happen every day in Indian e-commerce:

Wardrobing - someone buys a Rs.6,000 lehenga for a wedding, wears it once, and returns it. During festive season this spikes dramatically. We handle this with seasonal risk tightening - the system automatically becomes stricter during Diwali, Navratri, etc.

Size bracketing - a customer orders the same shirt in 3 sizes, keeps one, returns two. The merchant pays triple the shipping cost for what was essentially one sale. We detect this pattern at the cart level itself, before the order even ships.

Hardware swapping - in electronics, people return items with parts missing or swapped with cheaper components. We counter this with serial number and IMEI verification.

Courier collusion - delivery agents sometimes mark items as "refused" but keep them. We track this through GPS-stamped signatures and route analytics so honest buyers don't get blamed.

Slide 4 - Shopper & Merchant Dashboards (~25 sec)

The system works through two clean dashboards.

For shoppers - it's simple. One-click returns, live tracking from pickup to refund, and smart prompts that nudge toward

exchanges instead of refunds. Most genuine customers never even notice the fraud engine running behind the scenes.

For merchants - you get a full command center. Real-time KPIs showing return rates and losses prevented, an auto-triage queue that separates risky claims from genuine ones, and fraud sensitivity sliders you can tune per product category. Electronics might need stricter checks than daily wear, for example.

Slide 5 - Key Features (~20 sec)

Five things make this system powerful:

First - a 28-checkpoint risk engine that evaluates multiple signals, not just one metric. It looks at order history, device fingerprints, address patterns, return frequency - all together.

Second - pre-dispatch guards. We can flag wardrobing and size-bracketing before the item ships, saving the merchant shipping costs entirely.

Third - forensic verification. Photo proof, serial numbers, IMEI checks for high-value returns.

Fourth - a progressive escalation system. We don't ban customers on the first offense. There's a 5-step ladder - from soft warnings to temporary restrictions to full blocks. This protects customer relationships.

Fifth - delivery agent telemetry. We monitor the last-mile chain separately so courier fraud doesn't get mixed up with buyer fraud.

Slide 6 - Technology Stack (~12 sec)

Technically - React with Vite on the frontend for speed, Tailwind for styling, Django REST Framework on the backend delivering sub-second risk scoring, PostgreSQL for data with row-level security, and Redis with Celery for async processing. It's production-ready and designed to scale.

Slide 7 - Conclusion & Business Value (~25 sec)

To wrap up - let me share the business value ReturnGuard delivers:

ReturnGuard can reduce fraudulent return losses by 35 to 40 percent - that's massive for a small merchant doing Rs.50 lakh in monthly revenue.

We're seeing a 70% reduction in wardrobing abuse specifically, and merchants recover 3x their reverse logistics costs because we stop bad returns before they generate shipping expenses.

But here's the important part - 85%+ of genuine shoppers get instant approval. We're not creating friction for good customers. And for COD specifically, this system makes it safe for merchants to continue offering cash-on-delivery without bleeding money.

The architecture is scalable and modern - built with React + Vite and Django REST Framework, ready for enterprise integration.

Slide 8 - Uniqueness (~25 sec)

What makes ReturnGuard different from other fraud tools?

It's dual-sided. Most fraud tools only protect the merchant. We also reward good shoppers with faster, smoother refunds. Both sides benefit.

We intercept before dispatch. Most systems detect fraud after the return happens. We catch patterns like wardrobing and bracketing before the product even ships - saving two-way freight costs.

We separate courier fraud from buyer fraud. This is crucial. If a delivery agent steals a package, the customer shouldn't get a bad risk score. We use doorstep OTP and timestamp telemetry to differentiate.

Everything is auditable. Every flag, every override, every policy change - it's all logged in an immutable audit trail. If a customer disputes something, there's a complete evidence chain.

Slide 9 - Future Scope (~20 sec)

Going forward, four things on the roadmap:

Computer vision at the doorstep - using on-device AI to scan fabric quality and tag integrity during returns.

A consortium fraud graph - so serial fraudsters can be flagged across multiple merchants while preserving privacy.

A browser extension for Shopify and WooCommerce - bringing risk badges directly into the platforms merchants already use.

And UPI penny-drop refunds - for instant, automated bank verification and split refunds through Rs.1 UPI drops.

Slide 10 - Thank You (~8 sec)

That's ReturnGuard - protecting merchant margins while keeping the shopping experience smooth for genuine customers. Thank you. Happy to take questions or show a live demo.

Pacing Tips:

- * Slides 3 and 8 are your strongest - slow down and emphasize the examples
- * Slide 6 (Tech Stack) can be said quickly - it is just context
- * If running short on time, skip the future scope details
- * If you have extra time, expand on the wardrobing and courier collusion examples